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How to Solve WordPress Stuck in Maintenance Mode Errors

Yusuf Mudagal 22 Dec 2022 Updated 7 Aug 2026 3 min read

WordPress is a popular content management system that powers millions of websites around the world. However, sometimes things can go wrong and you may find your WordPress site stuck in maintenance mode. This can be frustrating, as it means that you can't access your site or make any updates.

If you're using CodeTrappers to manage your WordPress site, here's how you can solve this issue:

Check your site's .maintenance file

The first thing you should do is check for the presence of a .maintenance file in your site's root directory. This file is created by WordPress when it enters maintenance mode, and it's deleted when maintenance is complete. If the file is still there, it could be causing your site to stay in maintenance mode.

To fix this, simply delete the .maintenance file using an FTP client or your hosting control panel's file manager.

Check your site's database

If deleting the .maintenance file didn't solve the problem, it's possible that the issue is with your site's database. In the database, there's a table called wp_options that stores various settings for your WordPress site. If the value for the field named "maintenance_mode" is set to 1, it means that your site is in maintenance mode.

To fix this, you can either update the value of the "maintenance_mode" field to 0 using a database management tool like PHPMyAdmin, or you can run the following SQL query:

UPDATE wp_options SET option_value = '0' WHERE option_name = 'maintenance_mode';

Check for plugin conflicts

Sometimes, a plugin can cause your site to enter maintenance mode. If you recently installed or updated a plugin and that's when the issue started, it's worth checking if that plugin is causing the problem.

To do this, you can try deactivating all of your plugins and then reactivating them one by one. If the issue disappears after deactivating a specific plugin, then it's likely that the plugin is causing the problem. In that case, you can either try to fix the issue by updating or reinstalling the plugin, or you can contact the plugin developer for assistance.

Check your site’s .htaccess file

If none of the above solutions worked, it’s possible that the issue is with your site’s .htaccess file. This file is used to configure various server settings for your site, and it could be causing your site to stay in maintenance mode.

To fix this, you can try renaming your .htaccess file to .htaccess_backup and then accessing your site to see if the issue is resolved. If it is, you can then try restoring the original .htaccess file and making any necessary changes to fix the issue.

In conclusion, if your WordPress site is stuck in maintenance mode, there are a few steps you can take to try and fix the issue. By checking your site’s .maintenance file, database, and .htaccess file, and also checking for plugin conflicts, you should be able to solve the problem and get your site back up and running.

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